



INDUSTRY NEWS

MAKE IN INDIA

Global Hi-Fi system market to grow 5.2 per cent annually

The global Hi-Fi system market will grow annually at 5.2 per cent to reach \$12.463 billion by 2022, from \$9.674 billion in 2017—according to WiseGuyReports market research firm. Growing digitisation of systems is one of the major drivers of global Hi-Fi systems market. Booming demand for portable smart devices such as smartphones, tablets and laptops is strengthening the demand for wireless audio products. Emerging smart home industry and demand for Hi-Fi

systems in automobiles will further bolster the global Hi-Fi system market growth during the forecast period.

Residential application, which held the largest market share in 2016, will continue its dominance, while automotive application segment will witness the fastest growth.

Geographically, APAC region, which accounted for the largest share of Hi-Fi system market in 2016, will retain its position till the end of the projected period.

AI to feature in almost every new software by 2020

Market hype and growing interest in artificial intelligence (AI) are pushing established software vendors to introduce AI into their product strategy, creating considerable confusion in the process, according to Gartner, Inc. Analysts predict that by 2020, AI technologies will be virtually pervasive in almost every new software product and service. In fact, AI will be a top five investment priority for more than 30 per cent of CIOs.

Said Jim Hare, research vice president at Gartner, "AI offers exciting possibilities, but unfortunately, most vendors are focused on the goal of simply building and marketing an AI-based product rather than

first identifying needs, potential uses and the business value to customers."

The huge increase in startups and established vendors, all claiming to offer AI products without any real differentiation, is confusing buyers. More than a thousand vendors with applications and platforms describe themselves as AI vendors, or say they employ AI in their products. Advancements in AI, such as deep learning, are creating a lot of buzz but obfuscating the value of more straightforward, proven approaches. Also, more than half the respondents to Gartner's AI survey indicated the lack of necessary staff skills as the top challenge to adopting AI in their organisation.

India will lead the global mobile revolution

The global mobile penetration will reach 70 per cent by 2022, buoyed by the rising adoption in the Asia-Pacific region, especially India and China—

according to the latest Forrester report. India's mobile phone market will double in the coming five years, making the country lead the chart.

On The Move

Sundararajan becomes full-time telecom secretary, Sawhney gets MeitY

Aruna Sundararajan, secretary of IT and electronics, has taken full charge of the department of telecom (DoT), which till now was an additional charge given to her in May this year. Ajay Prakash Sawhney is now the new Ministry of Electronics and IT (MeitY) secretary in place of Sundararajan.

Subramanian is now Tata Sons' digital chief

Tata Sons has appointed Aarthi Subramanian as the group's chief digital officer. Subramanian, who was the executive director at Tata Consultancy Services, brings with her over 26 years of experience in the global technology sector. Starting her career with TCS, she has worked in diverse roles in India, Sweden, the US and Canada. As the group's chief digital officer, she will play a key role in driving digital adoption across group companies as well as the group's digital initiatives.

Raja quits Philips India

Philips India managing director V. Raja has resigned amidst a string of other senior-level exits. Expat Daniel Mazon from Latin America will now take charge of India operations. Mazon played a big part in turning around the Latin America business and was heading the healthcare business there.

The company's internal circular said that Raja, who had taken charge of the company in December 2015, is taking an early retirement on September 30 due to personal reasons.